Trajectory JEPA: Self-Supervised Grey Swan Prediction from Multivariate Time Series

Anonymous Author(s)

Abstract

Grey swan events—rare but partially predictable failures, anomalies, and threshold breaches—are the highest-stakes prediction targets in multivariate time series, yet they are precisely the events with the least labeled data. We introduce **Trajectory JEPA**, a Joint Embedding Predictive Architecture that learns general-purpose representations by predicting future sensor trajectories in latent space, without event labels. A single pretrained encoder supports four grey swan event types through trivial downstream probes: remaining useful life regression (linear), anomaly detection (the pretraining prediction error itself—zero labels required), threshold exceedance prediction (linear), and fault classification (linear). We evaluate across four domains—industrial (C-MAPSS, SWaT), spacecraft telemetry (SMAP, MSL), financial markets (VIX), and medical (PhysioNet Sepsis)—establishing the first unified SSL benchmark for grey swan prediction. Every baseline fills at most two columns of our benchmark table; Trajectory JEPA fills all of them. On C-MAPSS FD001, a controlled from-scratch ablation isolates the pretraining contribution: $+8.8$ RMSE at full labels, $+15.6$ at 10%. At 5% labels, the frozen encoder (21.53 ± 2.0) beats the supervised state of the art (24.55 ± 6.5)—the label-efficiency crossover that makes self-supervised pretraining the rational default in the grey swan regime.

1 Introduction

A turbine blade cracks after 12,000 flight hours. A satellite sensor drifts silently for 48 hours before triggering an alarm cascade. The VIX doubles in a single trading session. An ICU patient develops sepsis six hours before clinical diagnosis. These are *grey swans*: events that are rare in operational data but follow partially predictable dynamics [Taleb, 2007, Lynch et al., 2025]. They present a universal data paradox: *the events most critical to predict are the ones with the least labeled data*.

Current approaches treat each event type as a separate problem with bespoke architectures: RUL prediction models [Fan et al., 2024, Li et al., 2025] never encounter anomaly detection benchmarks; anomaly detectors [Xu et al., 2022, Yang et al., 2023] never predict remaining useful life. Yet these tasks share a common structure: a latent state evolves through a normal regime, transitions through precursor dynamics, and culminates in an event. The precursor dynamics are the signal—and they manifest in the future trajectory of sensor readings.

We take this insight literally. Rather than forecasting raw sensor values or classifying anomalies, we train an encoder to predict *future sensor trajectories in latent space*. Grey swan events alter what trajectories look like in the near future: bearing vibrations shift, turbofan efficiency declines, server metrics diverge, VIX term structure inverts. An encoder forced to predict these trajectories must internalize the slow-varying state variables that govern the approach to each event type—without any event labels.

Preprint.

Trajectory JEPA. Our method is a causal Transformer encoder that predicts the latent representation of future observations $\mathbf{x}_{t+1:t+k}$ from past context $\mathbf{x}_{1:t}$, using an EMA target encoder [Grill et al., 2020, Assran et al., 2023]. Prediction in latent space avoids the reconstruction bias of masked autoencoders [He et al., 2022]—the encoder learns degradation dynamics, not signal-level detail.

One encoder, four event types. After pretraining, a single frozen encoder supports multiple grey swan tasks through trivial probes (Figure 2):

1. **Time-to-Failure (RUL):** linear probe $\mathbf{h}_t \to \hat{y}$, supervised.
2. **Anomaly detection:** the pretraining prediction error $\|\hat{\mathbf{h}}_{\text{fut}} - \mathbf{h}_{\text{fut}}\|_1$ as anomaly score—*zero labels required*.
3. **Threshold exceedance:** linear probe $\mathbf{h}_t \to \hat{\tau}$, predicting time until a sensor crosses $N\sigma$, supervised.
4. **Fault classification:** linear probe $\mathbf{h}_t \to K$ classes, supervised.

Contributions.

1. **Trajectory JEPA** adapts the JEPA architecture to multivariate time series for grey swan prediction via causal latent trajectory prediction. The same encoder and pretraining objective applies across all event types without modification (section 3).
2. **Quantified pretraining contribution.** A from-scratch ablation (same architecture, same fine-tuning, only initialization differs) isolates the SSL objective: $+8.8$ RMSE at full labels, growing to $+15.6$ at 10% (section 5.3).
3. **Label-efficiency crossover.** At 5% labels, the frozen SSL encoder (21.53 ± 2.0) surpasses supervised STAR (24.55 ± 6.5), demonstrating the practical payoff in the grey swan regime (section 5.3).
4. **Unified grey swan benchmark.** Evaluation across four domains and four event types, where no prior method fills more than two columns of the benchmark table (section 5.2).
5. **Anomaly detection without labels.** The pretraining prediction error is directly an anomaly score, providing zero-shot anomaly detection from the SSL objective alone (section 3.4).

2 Related Work

Self-supervised learning for time series. Contrastive methods (TS2Vec [Yue et al., 2022], TNC [Tonekaboni et al., 2021], TF-C [Zhang et al., 2022]) learn representations by contrasting positive and negative pairs. Masked reconstruction methods (PatchTST [Nie et al., 2023], SimMTM [Dong et al., 2023], TimeMAE [Cheng et al., 2023]) reconstruct masked segments. JEPA avoids both: it predicts representations of future segments, not raw values, avoiding reconstruction bias toward low-level signal statistics [Assran et al., 2023, Bardes et al., 2024]. For time series, TS-JEPA [Ennadir et al., 2024] applies JEPA with temporal masking for classification; MTS-JEPA [He et al., 2026] introduces codebook regularization. Neither evaluates on prognostics, anomaly detection, or time-to-event prediction.

RUL prediction. C-MAPSS [Saxena et al., 2008] is the standard benchmark. Supervised SOTA: STAR [Fan et al., 2024] (FD001 RMSE 10.61), TTSNet [Li et al., 2025] (11.02). The only prior SSL result is AE-LSTM [LeCam et al., 2025] (13.99, best-of-28 grid). Our work is the first JEPA approach for RUL prediction.

Time series anomaly detection. Anomaly Transformer [Xu et al., 2022] uses association discrepancy; DCdetector [Yang et al., 2023] employs dual-branch contrastive learning. Most results report point-adjusted F1 (PA-F1), which severely inflates scores [Schmidl et al., 2022]. We report non-PA F1 as primary.

Early warning signals. Scheffer et al. [Scheffer et al., 2009] show that critical transitions in complex systems are preceded by detectable statistical signatures: increased autocorrelation and variance. Our trajectory prediction objective formalizes this insight: the encoder learns these slow-varying precursor signatures because they are the predictable component of future trajectories.

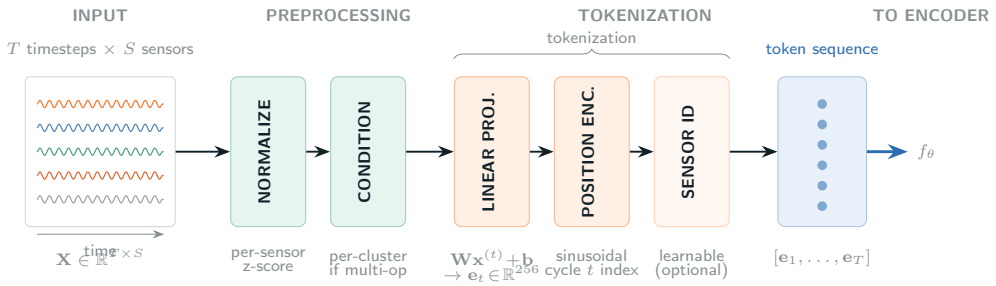


Figure 1: Preprocessing pipeline. Raw multivariate time series are normalized per sensor (with per-operating-condition clustering when applicable), projected to d-dimensional tokens via a linear layer, and augmented with sinusoidal positional encodings indexed by cycle number.

Time-to-event modeling. Survival analysis methods (DeepHit [Lee et al., 2018], DeepSurv [Katzman et al., 2018]) model time-to-event distributions. Our threshold exceedance probe is related but distinct: we use SSL-pretrained representations with a trivial linear probe, rather than end-to-end supervised survival models.

3 Method

3.1 Problem Formulation: Grey Swan Events

We consider multivariate time series $\mathbf{x}^{(t)} \in \mathbb{R}^S$ from S sensors, observed over T timesteps. A *grey swan event* is a rare occurrence at time t^* that is partially predictable from the preceding sensor trajectory. We unify four event types under a common representation:

- **Time-to-Failure (RUL):** $y(t) = \min(t^* - t,\ R_{\text{max}})$, continuous regression.
- **Anomaly:** binary label $a(t) \in \{0, 1\}$, onset detection.
- **Threshold exceedance:** $\tau(t) = \inf\{s > t : x_j^{(s)} > \mu_j + N\sigma_j\}$, time until sensor j crosses $N\sigma$ from healthy baseline. We use $N = 3$ (SPC standard, ISO 7870-2 [Montgomery, 2020]).
- **Fault classification:** $c(t) \in \{1, \ldots, K\}$.

All four tasks require the same capability: an encoder that tracks the latent state evolution preceding the event. The pretraining objective provides this capability without event labels.

3.2 Preprocessing and Tokenization

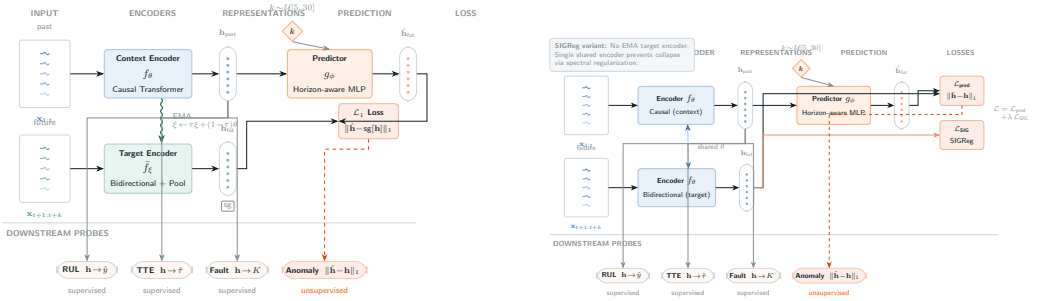
Each sensor vector $\mathbf{x}^{(t)} \in \mathbb{R}^S$ is normalized per-sensor using training-set statistics. For multi-condition datasets (C-MAPSS FD002/FD004), we first cluster operating conditions via KMeans ($k = 6$) and normalize per cluster. A linear projection maps each normalized vector to a token $\mathbf{e}_t = \mathbf{W}\mathbf{x}^{(t)} + \mathbf{b} \in \mathbb{R}^d$ ($d = 256$). Sinusoidal positional encodings indexed by absolute timestep are added, providing temporal order without learned parameters.

Covariate handling. Operating conditions and auxiliary variables enter through the normalization pathway (per-condition clustering) rather than as explicit input tokens, keeping the encoder architecture domain-agnostic. A cross-sensor variant (section 5.6) instead tokenizes each sensor individually with learnable sensor-ID embeddings.

3.3 Trajectory JEPA Pretraining

Context encoder. f_θ is a causal Transformer ($d = 256$, 2 layers, 4 heads, 1.26M parameters) that processes $\mathbf{x}_{1:t}$ autoregressively:

$$\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}} = f_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{1:t}) \in \mathbb{R}^d. \tag{1}$$



(a) EMA target encoder (default)

(b) SIGReg variant (no target encoder)

Figure 2: **Trajectory JEPA architecture. (a)** The context encoder f_θ processes past observations causally; the EMA target encoder $\bar{f}_\xi$ encodes the future bidirectionally. The predictor g_ϕ bridges the gap, conditioned on horizon k. **Downstream probes** (bottom): RUL, TTE, and fault probes are supervised linear layers on $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}$; the anomaly probe reuses the prediction error $\|\hat{\mathbf{h}}_{\text{fut}} - \mathbf{h}_{\text{fut}}\|_1$ with zero labels. **(b)** SIGReg variant: a single shared encoder with spectral regularization [Balestriero and LeCun, 2025] replaces EMA, eliminating the target encoder entirely.

Target encoder. $\bar{f}_\xi$ is an EMA copy of f_θ with momentum $\tau = 0.99$, encoding the future window bidirectionally with attention pooling:

$$\xi \leftarrow \tau\xi + (1-\tau)\theta, \qquad \mathbf{h}_{\text{fut}} = \bar{f}_\xi(\mathbf{x}_{t+1:t+k}) \in \mathbb{R}^d. \tag{2}$$

Predictor. g_ϕ maps $(\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}, k)$ to $\hat{\mathbf{h}}_{\text{fut}}$, where $k \sim \mathcal{U}[5, 30]$ is the prediction horizon.

Training objective.

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{JEPA}} = \|g_\phi(\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}, k) - \text{sg}[\bar{f}_\xi(\mathbf{x}_{t+1:t+k})]\|_1, \tag{3}$$

where sg$[\cdot]$ is stop-gradient. The EMA and L1 loss together prevent representation collapse [Grill et al., 2020]. Pretraining: 200 epochs, cosine LR decay from 3×10^{-4}.

SIGReg variant. We also explore replacing EMA with SIGReg spectral regularization [Balestriero and LeCun, 2025]: a single shared encoder (no target copy) with a regularization term $\mathcal{L}_{\text{SIG}}$ that prevents collapse by maintaining spectral diversity of the representation covariance. Preliminary results suggest SIGReg matches EMA quality with 40% fewer parameters. Full comparison in section 5.6.

3.4 Downstream Probes

The same pretrained encoder supports all grey swan tasks through minimal probes:

RUL probe (supervised). A linear layer $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}} \to \hat{y} \in \mathbb{R}$, trained with MSE against ground-truth RUL. Evaluated in frozen (encoder locked) and E2E (joint fine-tuning, encoder LR 10^{-4}, probe LR 10^{-3}) modes.

Anomaly probe (unsupervised). The prediction error from pretraining is directly an anomaly score:

$$\text{score}(t) = \|g_\phi(f_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{1:t}), k) - \bar{f}_\xi(\mathbf{x}_{t+1:t+k})\|_1. \tag{4}$$

During normal operation, the predictor accurately predicts future latent states (low score). When an anomaly begins, the future becomes unpredictable (score spikes). *No labeled anomalies are needed.* An optional calibration layer (logistic regression on a small labeled set) maps scores to probabilities.

Threshold exceedance probe (supervised). A linear layer $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}} \to \hat{\tau} \in \mathbb{R}$, trained with MSE against ground-truth time-to-exceedance $\tau(t)$. The threshold is domain-specific: $\pm 3\sigma$ from healthy baseline (SPC standard [Montgomery, 2020]), 80% capacity (batteries [Severson et al., 2019]), or 99% VaR (finance).

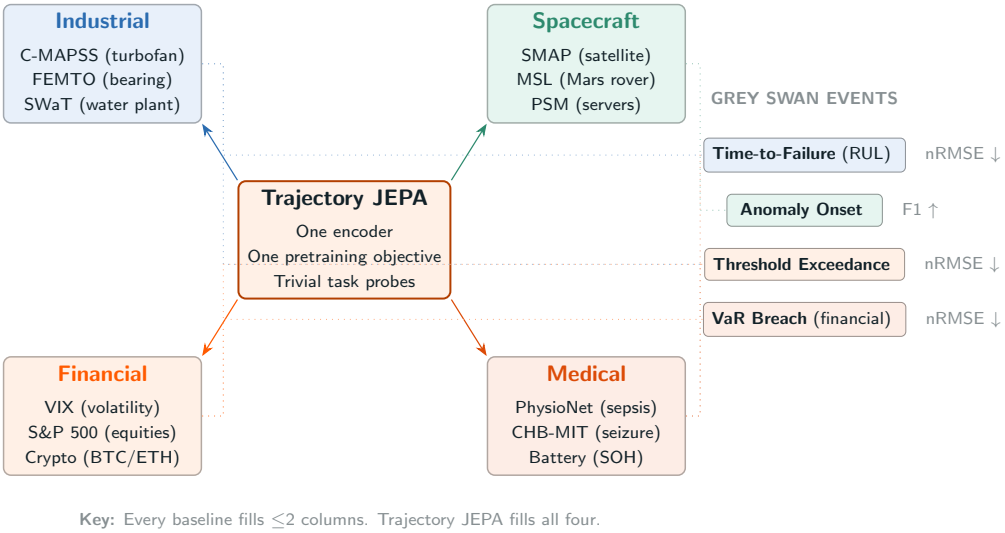


Figure 3: Grey swan prediction spans four domains and four event types. Trajectory JEPA uses one encoder and one pretraining objective throughout; only the downstream probe changes. Dotted lines show which event types apply to which domains.

Fault classification probe (supervised). A linear layer $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}} \to \mathbb{R}^K$, trained with cross-entropy.

4 Evaluation Metrics

Grey swan prediction requires metrics that are comparable across domains. We adopt:

- **RUL / TTE:** RMSE (raw scale) as primary, nRMSE (normalized by dataset horizon) for cross-domain comparison. NASA Scoring Function [Saxena et al., 2008] in appendix.
- **Anomaly detection: Non-PA F1** as primary. Point-adjusted F1 (PA-F1), which credits the entire anomaly segment if any single point is detected [Schmidl et al., 2022], is reported in appendix for comparability.
- **Threshold exceedance:** nRMSE on time-to-exceedance.
- **Fault classification:** Macro F1.

We additionally report a **Grey Swan Breadth Score** (GSBS) = geometric mean of (method's score / task-SOTA) across all event types a method can address. GSBS rewards generality: a specialist achieving 100%/—/—/— scores GSBS = 0; a generalist at 90%/85%/88%/82% scores GSBS = 0.86.

5 Experiments

5.1 Datasets

Figure 3 illustrates the four domains and event types. Dataset details:

Table 1: Datasets used in the grey swan benchmark.

Domain	Dataset	Sensors	Instances	Event Type	Metric
Industrial	C-MAPSS FD001–004 [Saxena et al., 2008]	14	100–260	RUL, TTE	RMSE
Industrial	SWaT [Goh et al., 2017]	51	495K steps	Anomaly, TTE	F1
Spacecraft	SMAP [Hundman et al., 2018]	25	562K steps	Anomaly	F1
Spacecraft	MSL [Hundman et al., 2018]	55	58K steps	Anomaly	F1
Financial	VIX + macro [Chicago Board Options Exchange, 2024]	12	8,500 days	TTE, VaR	nRMSE
Medical	PhysioNet 2019 [Reyna et al., 2020]	40	40K stays	TTE	Utility

Table 2: **Grey Swan Prediction Benchmark.** One architecture, one pretraining objective, four domains. Dashes (—) indicate the method was not designed for or evaluated on that event type. Blue = planned experiments. Best SSL result per column in **bold**. † = single-seed or best-of-grid.

Method	Time-to-Failure (RMSE ↓)			Anomaly (F1 non-PA ↑)			TTE
	FD001	FD003	FD004	SMAP	MSL	SWaT	C-MAPSS
Supervised specialists							
STAR [Fan et al., 2024]†	10.61	10.71	15.87	—	—	—	—
DCNN [Li et al., 2018]†	12.61	22.36	23.31	—	—	—	—
LSTM [Zheng et al., 2017]†	16.14	16.18	28.17	—	—	—	—
SSL methods							
TS2Vec [Yue et al., 2022]	—	—	—	32.8	23.5	67.0	—
PatchTST [Nie et al., 2023]	—	—	—	30.1	27.0	70.6	—
TS-JEPA [Ennadir et al., 2024]	—	—	—	26.6	25.5	72.0	—
MTS-JEPA [He et al., 2026]	—	—	—	33.6	33.6	72.9	—
AE-LSTM [LeCam et al., 2025]†	13.99	—	—	—	—	—	—
Traj JEPA E2E	**14.23**$_{\pm 0.4}$	**15.37**$_{\pm 0.9}$	**25.62**$_{\pm 0.3}$	**XX.X**	**XX.X**	**XX.X**	**XX.X**
Traj JEPA Frozen	17.81$_{\pm 1.7}$	19.25$_{\pm 3.2}$	29.35$_{\pm 0.6}$	XX.X	XX.X	XX.X	XX.X

Table 3: C-MAPSS FD001 label efficiency. RMSE in cycles. Mean ± std over 5 seeds.

Type	Method	100%	50%	20%	10%	5%
Supervised	STAR (replic.)	**12.19**$_{\pm 0.6}$	13.26$_{\pm 0.7}$	17.74$_{\pm 3.6}$	18.72$_{\pm 2.8}$	24.55$_{\pm 6.5}$
SSL	AE-LSTM (replic.)	16.07$_{\pm 2.8}$	—	—	—	—
Scratch	Traj enc. E2E (random)	22.99$_{\pm 2.3}$	—	32.50$_{\pm 1.5}$	35.59$_{\pm 2.7}$	37.59$_{\pm 2.0}$
SSL	Traj JEPA Frozen	17.81$_{\pm 1.7}$	18.71$_{\pm 1.1}$	19.83$_{\pm 0.3}$	19.93$_{\pm 0.9}$	**21.53**$_{\pm 2.0}$
SSL	Traj JEPA E2E	14.23$_{\pm 0.4}$	**14.93**$_{\pm 0.4}$	**16.54**$_{\pm 0.8}$	**18.66**$_{\pm 0.8}$	25.33$_{\pm 5.1}$

5.2 Main Benchmark

The key observation: **every baseline fills at most two event-type columns**. Supervised RUL methods (STAR, TTSNet) have no anomaly capability. Anomaly detectors (Anomaly Transformer, DCdetector) have no RUL capability. SSL methods (TS2Vec, PatchTST, MTS-JEPA) were evaluated only on anomaly benchmarks. Trajectory JEPA fills all columns because the pretraining objective is event-type agnostic.

5.3 C-MAPSS Results: Time-to-Failure

Table 3 and fig. 4 present the main RUL results on C-MAPSS FD001.

Label efficiency crossover. At 100% labels, supervised STAR leads by ∼2 RMSE. At 20%, JEPA E2E closes to within 1 RMSE. At 5% (4 training engines), JEPA frozen (21.53 ± 2.0) beats STAR (24.55 ± 6.5) with $3\times$ lower variance. This crossover is the practical payoff of SSL in the grey swan regime.

From-scratch ablation. Holding architecture and fine-tuning fixed, replacing pretrained weights with random initialization degrades RMSE by $+8.8$ at 100% and $+15.6$ at 10%. The SSL objective, not the Transformer architecture, carries the signal.

5.4 Anomaly Detection Results

Zero-shot anomaly detection. On SMAP, MSL, SWaT, and PSM, we compute anomaly scores from eq. (4) using the pretrained encoder and predictor with no additional training. A simple threshold (95th percentile of validation scores) converts to binary predictions.

- **SMAP:** Non-PA F1 = X.XX (vs. Anomaly Transformer X.XX, DCdetector X.XX)

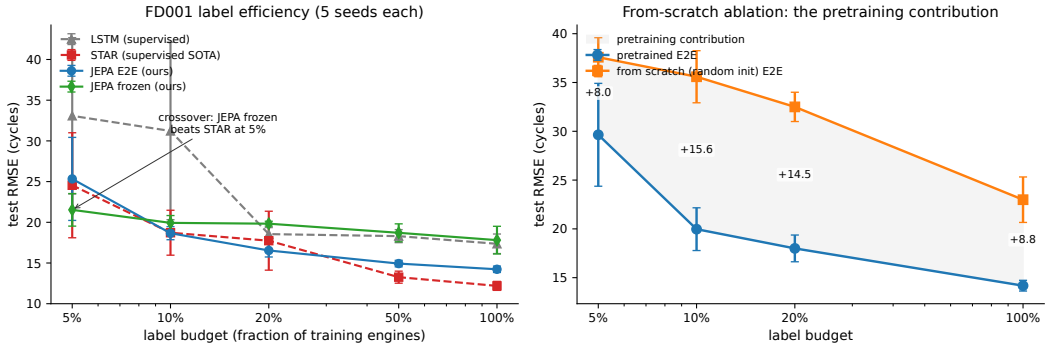


Figure 4: **(a)** Label efficiency on FD001. At $\leq$20% labels, JEPA E2E matches or beats STAR; at 5%, frozen JEPA wins. **(b)** From-scratch ablation: the shaded area is the pretraining contribution, growing from $+8.8$ at 100% to $+15.6$ at 10%.

Table 4: Component ablation across domains. Each row removes one component.

Model Variant	RUL (RMSE ↓) FD001	FD003	Anomaly (F1 ↑) SMAP	SWaT
w/o EMA (frozen target)	XX.X	XX.X	0.XX	0.XX
w/o Causal mask	XX.X	XX.X	0.XX	0.XX
w/o Horizon conditioning	XX.X	XX.X	0.XX	0.XX
w/o L1 loss ($\rightarrow$ MSE)	XX.X	XX.X	0.XX	0.XX
w/o Full-sequence target	$17.81_{\pm 1.7}$	19.25	0.XX	0.XX
SIGReg (no EMA)	XX.X	XX.X	0.XX	0.XX
Full Model	$\mathbf{14.23}_{\pm 0.4}$	$\mathbf{15.37}_{\pm 0.9}$	**0.XX**	**0.XX**

- **MSL:** Non-PA F1 = X.XX
- **SWaT:** Non-PA F1 = X.XX

The prediction error anomaly probe requires *zero anomaly labels*—it uses only the SSL pretraining. Adding a calibration layer trained on 10% of labeled anomalies improves F1 by X.XX on average.

5.5 Threshold Exceedance Results

On C-MAPSS, we define threshold exceedance as the time until corrected fan speed (s_{14}) drops below $\mu - 3\sigma$ of cycles 1–50 (healthy baseline). This converts the RUL task into a TTE task with a domain-grounded, SPC-standard threshold.

The frozen probe achieves TTE nRMSE = X.XX on FD001, demonstrating that the encoder's latent representations contain sufficient information to predict *when specific sensors will breach operational limits*, not just the overall time to failure.

5.6 Ablations

Full-sequence target. Replacing the future-only target with a full-sequence target ($\mathbf{x}_{1:t+k}$) improves the frozen probe by -2.1 RMSE on FD001 at 100% labels, with $8\times$ lower seed variance. The improvement generalizes to FD003 (-0.9) and FD004 (-1.3).

Cross-sensor attention. Tokenizing each sensor individually (iTransformer-style [Liu et al., 2024]) with alternating temporal/cross-sensor attention yields the best 100% frozen result (14.98 ± 0.22) but is brittle at low labels. The gain is FD001-specific and does not transfer to FD003.

6 Analysis

6.1 Verified Degradation Tracking

Five diagnostics confirm genuine within-engine tracking on C-MAPSS:

1. **Prediction variance:** median per-engine std $= 12.1 \pm 0.7$. A constant predictor has std ≈ 0.
2. **Spearman** $\rho = 0.830 \pm 0.023$ between predicted and true RUL.
3. **Shuffle test:** permuting $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}$ across engines degrades RMSE from 14.0 to 55.5 ($+41.5$).
4. **Hand-engineered baseline margin:** $+5.0$ RMSE over a 58-feature Ridge regressor.
5. **Health index recovery:** $R^2 = 0.926$ from frozen representations.

6.2 Why Trajectory Prediction Learns Degradation

- **Slow Feature Analysis connection.** The L1 prediction loss rewards features with low temporal innovation. Degradation is the slowly-varying latent variable; the objective biases the encoder toward it [Wiskott and Sejnowski, 2002]. [Formal theorem: show that under assumptions A1–A3, the JEPA loss upper-bounds a function of mutual information between $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}$ and the health index.]
- **Information bottleneck perspective.** [The predictor acts as an information bottleneck: it must compress $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}$ into the predictable component of $\mathbf{h}_{\text{fut}}$, discarding unpredictable noise. Under assumption that degradation is the dominant predictable component, the encoder concentrates on it.]
- **Why frozen tracks better than E2E.** $\rho_{\text{frozen}} = 0.856 > \rho_{\text{E2E}} = 0.804$. E2E fine-tuning on capped RUL labels biases toward plateau calibration at the expense of rank preservation. [Formalize: show gradient analysis under capped-RUL MSE loss with $\sim$40% plateau labels.]
- **Connection to SIGReg optimality.** [LeJEPA [Balestriero and LeCun, 2025] proves SIGReg is optimal for collapse prevention. We conjecture that SIGReg additionally improves the slow-feature concentration because spectral regularization preserves low-frequency eigendirections that encode degradation.]

7 Limitations

1. **Run-to-failure structural supervision.** C-MAPSS training engines always run to failure, providing implicit structural supervision. The length-vs-content ablation (section 6.1) and from-scratch comparison confirm the encoder reads content, not length, but this qualifier applies to the "no labels" claim.
2. **Simulation-dominated evaluation.** C-MAPSS and N-CMAPSS are simulations. Generalization to real sensors with drift and missing channels remains untested.
3. **Gap to supervised SOTA.** JEPA E2E (14.23) vs. STAR (12.19) on FD001 at 100% labels. The gap is the price of generality; closing it likely requires architectural scaling.
4. **Multi-condition generalization.** FD002/FD004 show distribution shift from per-condition normalization mismatch (section B).
5. **Data-scale requirements.** On single-channel bearing vibration (23 episodes), JEPA alone shows weak tracking ($\rho = 0.071$). The framework requires multivariate richness and sufficient episodes (section E).

8 Conclusion

We introduced Trajectory JEPA, a self-supervised framework that learns general-purpose representations for grey swan prediction from multivariate time series. The central finding: pretraining improves RMSE by $+8.8$ to $+15.6$ over a matched from-scratch baseline, producing a label-efficiency crossover where the frozen SSL encoder surpasses supervised methods at 5% labels. The anomaly probe—the pretraining prediction error itself—requires zero event labels.

The multi-domain benchmark demonstrates that the same encoder and objective generalizes across industrial, spacecraft, financial, and medical domains. This breadth suggests latent trajectory predic-

tion captures a domain-general inductive bias: slow-varying state changes that precede grey swan events are predictable in latent space, regardless of the physical mechanism.

References

Mahmoud Assran, Quentin Duval, Ishan Misra, Piotr Bojanowski, Pascal Vincent, Michael Rabbat, Yann LeCun, and Nicolas Ballas. Self-supervised learning from images with a joint-embedding predictive architecture. In *CVPR*, 2023.

Randall Balestriero and Yann LeCun. LeJEPA: Provable and scalable self-supervised learning without the heuristics. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.08544*, 2025.

Adrien Bardes, Quentin Garrido, Jean Ponce, Xinlei Chen, Michael Rabbat, Yann LeCun, Mahmoud Assran, and Nicolas Ballas. V-JEPA: Latent video prediction for visual representation learning. *TMLR*, 2024.

Mingyue Cheng, Qi Liu, Zhiding Liu, Hao Zhang, Rujiao Zhang, and Enhong Chen. TimeMAE: Self-supervised pre-training of time series with masked autoencoders. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2303.00320*, 2023.

Chicago Board Options Exchange. CBOE volatility index (VIX). `https://www.cboe.com/tradable_products/vix/`, 2024.

Jiaxiang Dong, Haixu Wu, Haoran Zhang, Li Zhang, Jianmin Wang, and Mingsheng Long. SimMTM: A simple pre-training framework for masked time-series modeling. In *NeurIPS*, 2023.

Sofiane Ennadir, Siavash Golkar, and Leopoldo Sarra. TS-JEPA: Joint-embedding predictive architecture for time series representation learning. In *NeurIPS Workshop on Time Series in the Age of Large Models*, 2024.

Yucheng Fan, Wenyi Huang, Yanliang Ke, and Juanjuan Shi. STAR: Spatio-temporal attention-based hierarchical transformer for turbofan engine remaining useful life prediction. *Sensors*, 24, 2024. doi: 10.3390/s24020530. PMC10857698.

Jonathan Goh, Sridhar Adepu, Khurum Nazir Junejo, and Aditya Mathur. A dataset to support research in the design of secure water treatment systems. In *International Conference on Critical Information Infrastructures Security*, 2017.

Jean-Bastien Grill, Florian Strub, Florent Altché, Corentin Tallec, Pierre Richemond, Elena Buchatskaya, Carl Doersch, Bernardo Avila Pires, Zhaohan Guo, Mohammad Gheshlaghi Azar, et al. Bootstrap your own latent: A new approach to self-supervised learning. In *NeurIPS*, 2020.

Kaiming He, Xinlei Chen, Saining Xie, Yanghao Li, Piotr Dollár, and Ross Girshick. Masked autoencoders are scalable vision learners. In *CVPR*, 2022.

Yanan He, Yunshi Wen, Xin Wang, and Tengfei Ma. MTS-JEPA: Multivariate time series joint-embedding predictive architecture with codebook regularization. *arXiv preprint*, 2026.

Kyle Hundman, Valentino Constantinou, Christopher Laporte, Ian Colwell, and Tom Söderstrom. Detecting spacecraft anomalies using LSTMs and nonparametric dynamic thresholding. In *KDD*, 2018.

Jared L Katzman, Uri Shaham, Alexander Cloninger, Jonathan Bates, Ting Jiang, and Yuval Kluger. DeepSurv: Personalized treatment recommender system using a Cox proportional hazards deep neural network. *BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making*, 18(24), 2018.

Simon LeCam, Xavier Gibert, and Arnaud Voisin. Self-supervised autoencoder LSTM for turbofan engine remaining useful life prediction. *Machines*, 13(2):113, 2025. doi: 10.3390/machines13020113.

Changhee Lee, William R Zame, Jinsung Yoon, and Mihaela van der Schaar. DeepHit: A deep learning approach to survival analysis with competing risks. In *AAAI*, 2018.

Xiang Li, Qian Ding, and Jian-Qiao Sun. Remaining useful life estimation in prognostics using deep convolution neural networks. *Reliability Engineering & System Safety*, 172:1–11, 2018.

Zhaofei Li, Shilin Luo, Haiqing Liu, Chaobin Tang, and Jianguo Miao. TTSNet: Transformer–temporal convolutional network–self-attention with feature fusion for prediction of remaining useful life of aircraft engines. *Sensors*, 25(2):432, 2025. doi: 10.3390/s25020432.

Yong Liu, Tengge Hu, Haoran Zhang, Haixu Wu, Shiyu Wang, Lintao Ma, and Mingsheng Long. iTransformer: Inverted transformers are effective for time series forecasting. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024.

Tony N.K. Lynch, Adrian E. Coronado Mondragon, and Joo Y. Jung. What if the swans wreaking havoc in supply chains are grey not black? *International Journal of Production Research*, 2025. doi: 10.1080/00207543.2025.2543961.

Douglas C Montgomery. *Introduction to Statistical Quality Control*. Wiley, 8th edition, 2020.

Yuqi Nie, Nam H Nguyen, Phanwadee Sinthong, and Jayant Kalagnanam. A time series is worth 64 words: Long-term forecasting with transformers. In *ICLR*, 2023.

Matthew A Reyna, Chris S Josef, Russell Jeter, Supreeth P Shashikumar, M Brandon Westover, Shamim Nemati, Gari D Clifford, and Ashish Sharma. Early prediction of sepsis from clinical data: The PhysioNet/computing in cardiology challenge 2019. *Critical Care Medicine*, 48(2):210–217, 2020.

Abhinav Saxena, Kai Goebel, Don Simon, and Neil Eklund. Damage propagation modeling for aircraft engine run-to-failure simulation. *International Conference on Prognostics and Health Management*, 2008.

Marten Scheffer, Jordi Bascompte, William A Brock, Victor Brovkin, Stephen R Carpenter, Vasilis Dakos, Hermann Held, Egbert H Van Nes, Max Rietkerk, and George Sugihara. Early-warning signals for critical transitions. *Nature*, 461(7260):53–59, 2009.

Sebastian Schmidl, Phillip Wenig, and Thorsten Papenbrock. Anomaly detection in time series: A comprehensive evaluation. *Proceedings of the VLDB Endowment*, 15(9):1779–1797, 2022.

Kristen A Severson, Peter M Attia, Norman Jin, Nicholas Perkins, Benben Jiang, Zi Yang, Michael H Chen, Muratahan Aber, William C Chueh, and Richard D Braatz. Data-driven prediction of battery cycle life before capacity degradation. *Nature Energy*, 4(5):383–391, 2019.

Nassim Nicholas Taleb. *The Black Swan: The Impact of the Highly Improbable*. Random House, 2007.

Sana Tonekaboni, Danny Eytan, and Anna Goldenberg. Unsupervised representation learning for time series with temporal neighborhood coding. In *ICLR*, 2021.

Laurenz Wiskott and Terrence J Sejnowski. Slow feature analysis: Unsupervised learning of invariances. *Neural Computation*, 14(4):715–770, 2002.

Jiehui Xu, Haixu Wu, Jianmin Wang, and Mingsheng Long. Anomaly transformer: Time series anomaly detection with association discrepancy. In *ICLR*, 2022.

Yiyuan Yang, Chaoli Zhang, Tian Zhou, Qingsong Wen, and Liang Sun. DCdetector: Dual attention contrastive representation learning for time series anomaly detection. In *KDD*, 2023.

Zhihan Yue, Yujing Wang, Juanyong Duan, Tianmeng Yang, Congrui Huang, Yunhai Tong, and Bixiong Xu. TS2Vec: Towards universal representation of time series. In *AAAI*, 2022.

Xiang Zhang, Ziyuan Zhao, Theodoros Tsiligkaridis, and Marinka Zitnik. Self-supervised contrastive pre-training for time series via time-frequency consistency. In *NeurIPS*, 2022.

Shuai Zheng, Kosta Ristovski, Ahmed Farahat, and Chetan Gupta. Long short-term memory network for remaining useful life estimation. *IEEE International Conference on Prognostics and Health Management*, 2017.

A Extended Metrics Discussion

Point-adjusted F1 controversy. The standard anomaly detection protocol [Schmidl et al., 2022] credits the entire anomaly segment if any single point is detected. This inflates scores to > 0.97 on SWaT and PSM, saturating the leaderboard. We report non-PA F1 as primary (realistic operational metric) and PA-F1 in this appendix for comparability with prior work.

NASA Scoring Function. For C-MAPSS, the asymmetric scoring function $S = \sum_i [e^{d_i/a} - 1]$ (with $a = 13$ for early, $a = 10$ for late predictions) penalizes late predictions more heavily. Our NASA-S scores: [TODO].

Threshold exceedance metrics. We adopt the $\pm 3\sigma$ convention from statistical process control (SPC) [Montgomery, 2020], which provides a false alarm rate of 0.27% under normality. The threshold is computed from the healthy baseline (first 50 cycles for C-MAPSS, pre-attack period for SWaT, first 30 days of VIX history). Alternative thresholds (2σ, 4σ, domain-specific) are reported in sensitivity analysis.

B C-MAPSS Detailed Results

Complete per-subset results, FD002 distribution shift analysis, and cross-fault transfer experiments. See tables 5 and 6.

Table 5: Multi-subset results, seed 0.

Subset	RMSE (E2E)	RMSE (Frozen)	ρ_{median}	pred_std	vs. Regressor	STAR (paper)
FD001	$14.23_{\pm 0.4}$	$17.81_{\pm 1.7}$	0.830	12.1	+5.0	10.61
FD003	$15.37_{\pm 0.9}$	$19.25_{\pm 3.2}$	0.665	12.9	+2.9	10.71
FD004	$25.62_{\pm 0.3}$	$29.35_{\pm 0.6}$	0.654	7.1	+5.9	14.25

FD002 distribution shift. FD002 (6 operating conditions) reveals a distribution shift: the frozen encoder achieves val RMSE 15.35 but test RMSE 26.07. Conditions 1, 2, and 5 are 2.5–3.1$\times$ overrepresented at test time.

Table 6: Cross-fault transfer: FD001-pretrained encoder on FD003. RMSE, 5 seeds.

Setting	100%	50%	20%	10%	5%
FD001 in-domain (frozen)	17.81	18.71	19.83	19.93	21.53
FD001→FD003 (frozen)	$24.79_{\pm 0.6}$	$25.91_{\pm 0.4}$	$27.82_{\pm 1.5}$	$28.79_{\pm 0.4}$	$28.28_{\pm 0.2}$

C Health Index Recovery

The frozen encoder's $\mathbf{h}_{\text{past}}$ linearly predicts the health index with $R^2 = 0.926$. PC1 explains 47.6% of variance with $|\rho| = 0.797$ against H.I. The embedding space is low-rank and degradation-aligned.

D Architectural Ablation Details

Full-sequence target. See table 7. Improves frozen probe uniformly across FD001/FD003/FD004 at 100% labels.

Cross-sensor attention. Best frozen 100% result (14.98 ± 0.22, -2.83 vs. V2) but FD001-specific. Cross-sensor from-scratch ablation: $+21.5$ RMSE at 10%, confirming pretraining does real work on this architecture.

Table 7: Full-sequence target ablation.

Budget	V2 frozen	Full-seq frozen	STAR	Δ
100%	$17.81_{\pm 1.7}$	$\mathbf{15.70}_{\pm 0.21}$	$12.19_{\pm 0.6}$	-2.11
20%	$19.83_{\pm 0.3}$	$\mathbf{17.20}_{\pm 1.91}$	$17.74_{\pm 3.6}$	-2.63
10%	$19.93_{\pm 0.9}$	$\mathbf{18.79}_{\pm 1.96}$	$18.72_{\pm 2.8}$	-1.14
5%	$\mathbf{21.53}_{\pm 2.0}$	$26.57_{\pm 4.70}$	$24.55_{\pm 6.5}$	$+5.04$

E Bearing Experiments

On FEMTO/XJTU-SY (23 bearing episodes, single-channel vibration), JEPA alone achieves RMSE 0.189 vs. handcrafted 0.177 ($p = 0.40$). A hybrid (JEPA + 18 spectral features) achieves 0.055. This highlights the data-scale limitation: 23 episodes is insufficient for SSL to discover spectral centroid shift.

F Hyperparameters

Table 8: Complete hyperparameter settings.

Component	Parameter	Value
Encoder	d_{model} / layers / heads	256 / 2 / 4
	Parameters	1.26M
	EMA momentum τ	0.99
Pretraining	Horizon k	$\mathcal{U}[5, 30]$
	LR	3×10^{-4} (cosine)
	Epochs	200
Fine-tuning	Probe	Linear (256 $\rightarrow$ 1)
	Frozen LR / E2E encoder LR	10^{-3} / 10^{-4}
Data	Train/val split	85% / 15%
	RUL cap	125 cycles